

Faith over fear

Transcript of the God's Design podcast episode

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Good day and welcome to the podcast, Faith Over Fear. My name is Ashton. Today we're reading from Daniel chapter 3, verses 1 to 6. Nebuchadnezzar, the king, made an image of gold, whose height was three score cubits, and the breadth of six cubits. He set it up in the plain of Dura, in the province of Babylon. Then an herald cried out, To you it is commanded, O people, nations, and languages, that at the time ye hear the sound of the cornet, the flute, the harp, the sackbut, the psalter, the dulcimer, and all kinds of music, he fall down and worship the golden image that Nebuchadnezzar the king has set up.

And whosoever falleth not down and worshipeth, shall the same hour be cast into the midst of the burning fire of furnace. When we look at the news today, the news is always filled with some type of terror attack, some shooting, some robbery, some kind of gender-based violence. As a Christian believer, in Christ, we are no longer slaves to fear, and should never fall prey to it. Because the goal of fear is to paralyze you and to weaken you from that which God has blessed you with, and that is faith.

We are living in a world that is held captive by fear. You can only live a fearless life in a fearful world if you are rooted in Christ Jesus and in the word of God. Every day, we are presented with the opportunity to be afraid through media outlets. But as Christians, we rely on our source, which is God the Father, to protect us through all circumstances. As of old, when King Nebuchadnezzar had raised up that image, he had put a fierce structure over the people and had threatened their lives, that if they do not conform to his way, then they will be cast into the fiery furnace.

His Babylonian persuasions kept the people under the constant threat of fear or loss, while simultaneously securing the advancement of his Babylonian system. We find evidence of this persuasion in almost every aspect of life here on earth, in the medical industry, government agencies, insurance industries, media, and so on. So, when you hear of things like the new normal, the new normal is rooted in fear. It is a system that has eroded your confidence in

what used to be, and has provided you with a fear-based alternative to say that if you do not comply with the new normal, this and that is going to happen to you.

Babylon is trying to erode our trust and confidence in our Lord and Saviour, Jesus Christ. As we read on, Daniel chapter 3, verse 16 to 17, 18 and 19, Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego answered and said to the king, O Nebuchadnezzar, we are not careful to answer thee in this matter. If it be so, our God, whom we serve, is able to deliver us from the burning fiery furnace. O Nebuchadnezzar, Meshach, is able to send the word from the Lord and Saviour, to give us permission to deliver us from the stormwater.

And he will deliver us out of thine hand. O king, but if not, be it known unto thee, O king, that we will not serve thy gods, nor worship the golden image which thou hast set up. Then was Nebuchadnezzar full of fury, and the form of his visage was changed against Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego. Therefore he spake, and commanded that they should heat the furnace seven times more than it was. It was at this time that their faith demanded that they do not back down from the fear of the fire.

Their faith required them to speak in agreement with what God has planned for their lives. You now have to agree with God on the matter that is before you, and not with the enemy. These men's faith in God could not resist the opportunity to let the enemy know, to let fear know, that they were not afraid, even with the threat of the increasing of the heat of the fire seven times. Proverbs 1 verse 33 says, But whosoever hearkened unto me shall dwell safely, and shall be quiet from fear of evil.

Protection from fear is simply listening for God's direction and instruction in your life, in every situation that you are presented with. While we do live in a world that is infested with fear, we as the Bible-believing Christians who have faith in Christ Jesus are exempted from fear's effects in our lives if we practice our faith concerning it. And freedom from fear does not happen without the trying of your faith. Fear is always going to try your faith.

The world has many fear-based systems, but you need to practice your faith to dwell in the presence of your Father before you react or respond to faith in fear. Proverbs 29 verse 25 reads, The fear of man bringeth a snare, but those who put his trust in the Lord shall be safe. When trouble arises, try, stand, activate your faith instead of activating your fear. James chapter 1 verses 2 to 4 says, My brother, count it all joy when he fall into diverse temptations, knowing this, that the trying of your faith work at patience, but let patience have a perfect work, that he may be perfected and entire, wanting nothing.

Your capacity for endurance is developed when you practice and test your faith in the face of fear opportunities presented to you. Proverbs 3 verse 25 says, Be not afraid of sudden fear,

neither of the desolation of the wicked when it comes. God's promises have not changed. When he said to Joshua in chapter 1 verses 5 and 6, As I was with Moses, so shall I be with thee. I will not fail thee, nor forsake thee. Be strong and of good courage. And with that, Joshua's success was based upon his confidence and trust in God.

God... He basically told Joshua, I'll be with you. I won't leave you. I won't fail you. So don't be afraid. If you truly follow God, you will always overcome fear of any kind in your life. God bless you.